



Kyanite

△ Gem kyanite rough showing unusual thickness

Usually blue or blue-grey, and generally mixed or zoned within a single crystal, kyanite can also be green, orange, or colourless. Kyanite mainly occurs as elongated blades that are often bent, and less commonly as radiating, columnar aggregates. Kyanite is formed during the metamorphism of clay-rich sediments. It occurs in mica schists, gneisses, and associated hydrothermal quartz veins. Until recently it was not considered a gem mineral, but in the last decades transparent material has been found. Stones cut from it rival blue sapphire in intensity of colour.

Specification

Chemical name	Aluminium silicate	Formula	Al_2SiO_5
Colours	Blue, green, orange, colourless	Structure	
Triclinic	Hardness 4.5–7	SG 3.5–3.7	RI 1.71–1.73
Lustre	Vitreous	Streak	Colourless
Locations	Brazil, Switzerland, USA		

Rich blue kyanite blades | Rough | These matrix examples consist of kyanite blades in schist and display the finest dark blue colouring.



Bladed kyanite crystals | Rough | Kyanite classically forms relatively thin, bladed crystals, such as these gem-quality specimens in a matrix.



Kyanite sphere | Carved | The skill of the lapidary is evident in this carved sphere, as the blue kyanite is set in calcite, which is much softer than the kyanite.



Fine oval | Colour variety | While it is not the deepest kyanite blue, the colour of this oval brilliant gem is close to that of fine Burmese sapphire.



Ear clips | Set | This pair of flower head ear clips is set with rich blue kyanite oval-cut stones, each of which is surrounded by a fringe of tiny diamonds.